



INDIA

WEST DARJEELING VALLEY

Home to some of the oldest tea gardens in West Bengal, West Darjeeling Valley sits at an elevation of 6,890ft (2,100m). The Happy Valley Tea Estate (1854), located north of the town, is the oldest estate in Darjeeling.

TEESTA VALLEY

The Teesta River flows from the Himalayas into this valley, which is home to a rich biodiverse environment. Tea gardens of note including Samabeong, Teesta Valley garden, and Glenburn, which has a resort hotel in the heritage bungalows near the tea gardens.

EAST DARJEELING VALLEY**EAST DARJEELING VALLEY**

Also referred to as Golden Valley, tea gardens in this area benefit from the cold winds that blow down from the Himalayan mountains. Many of the plants in this region are pure "China" leaf or var. *sinensis*.

MIRIK VALLEY

This valley shares a border with Nepal, and the Himalayas are clearly visible from the slopes of the tea gardens. There are many renowned tea estates in Mirik, such as Thurbo and Seeyok.

FLUSH

Tea is harvested three times a year with a dormant period between each picking season. Each "flush," or surge of bud growth on the tea plant, has a distinct flavor character. First flush is the most piquant, second flush has a complex profile, while autumnal flush has deeper maltier flavors.

NORTH DINAJPUR**KEY**

 NOTABLE TEA-PRODUCING REGIONS

 AREA OF PRODUCTION

First flush Darjeeling
tea leaves are warm brown in color with green tones.